

emphasises that Glance's platform is designed to know, learn, experience, and constantly grow with its user's likes and dislikes with time.

The future of Glance is as dynamic as its content. With Glance 2.0, Shah envisions a platform that covers the entire "intent to inspiration spectrum." This means live experience zones catering to specific interests, from fitness to sports, and an expansion into global markets. Recently, Glance made its foray into Japan and Latin America, with plans to launch in the United States soon. "We are already present in India and Indonesia, which are the most matured markets for us so far," Shah adds. In India and Southeast Asia, Glance claims to have established a strong foothold, with its smart lock-screen platform bundled with various OEMs enjoying an active user base of over 230 million.

Looking at the broader industry perspective, the transformation of the smartphone lock screen landscape over the next decade is poised to be significant. Experts predict that AI-driven personalisation and live entertainment will dramatically change how people interact with their smartphones. By all indications, Shah is at the forefront of this transformation, with Glance leading the charge.

Not just the lock screen, even monetisation – a crucial aspect for any startup – is approached creatively at Glance. The platform collaborates with advertisers to deliver personalised experiences and content. Shah explains, "Through full-screen imagery, brands can capture audience attention even before they unlock their phones." It's an innovative approach, turning the lock screen into a new frontier for advertising like never before – not counting a few annoyed users who would prefer not to see any ads on their screen, of course.

Advertising is meaningless without data, and how that data is gathered, stored and respected matters. Data privacy, a paramount concern in today's digital ecosystem, is not lost

on Shah and his team. He assures, "At Glance, we prioritise privacy with utmost seriousness. Every feature of Glance is designed to be privacy compliant." Glance doesn't collect any personal information without express consent from the consumer, as required by the laws of the land. The signals collected through the consumer's interaction on the Glance platform are only used to improve the recommendations on the lock screen and be able to add higher value in a consumer's life by bringing them content that they indicate is most relevant to them, Shah emphasises further. This reassurance is crucial in maintaining user trust, especially in a world increasingly sceptical of data misuse.



Content curation at Glance is a blend of strategic partnerships and technological prowess. Shah elaborates, "We work with over 500 partners across various domains globally, ensuring a steady stream of fresh and personalised content." This network of partnerships is vital in keeping the content on Glance relevant and engaging, ensuring maximum user delight every step of the way. User feedback is another key ingredient in Glance's recipe for success. Shah acknowledges, "User feedback is integral to our platform development." This feedback loop allows Glance to constantly evolve, adapting to the ever-changing tastes and preferences of its users.

Standing out in the crowded marketplace of content platforms is no small feat. Shah attributes this success to Glance's unique approach. "We believe in less is more," he says. Consumers love Glance because they know Glance will provide them with something

that is meaningful, such as learning a new word in a day, learning a new recipe, reading a positive quote before sleeping and keeping updated with the latest news and cricket scores, Shah mentions. By focusing on delivering meaningful content, Glance avoids the trap of overstimulation and content fatigue that plagues many digital platforms today.

Collaborations have played a significant role in Glance's trajectory. Partnerships with giants like Jio Platforms, Google, and Mithril Capital have not only provided financial backing but also strategic guidance. "These collaborations have been instrumental in our product expansion and international growth," Shah acknowledges.

Looking beyond smartphones, Glance is eyeing expansion into other devices like tablets, smartwatches, and smart TVs. "Consider Glance as the Internet of Surfaces, where we're essentially creating an operating system for digital surfaces," Shah says, hinting at the broader vision of the company to integrate its platform across various digital interfaces. Don't be surprised if you see a Glance-enabled smartwatch in the not-too-distant future.

Imagine all of this built on such a simple and basic human habit – when we merely look at our digital screens. By my understanding, Glance isn't a social network, neither is it a UGC (user generated content) platform. Glance doesn't feel like a fleeting trend or an intrusive add-on to the Android ecosystem, for users who want more from their digital experiences. From all indications, it's a disruptive undertaking by Piyush Shah and his team, trying to reshape the journey of how content is consumed on smartphones and beyond. With a focus on user-centric design, innovative use of technology, and strategic partnerships, Glance has its sights set on transforming the way we interact with our most personal devices. "We're not just a platform; we're a new way of experiencing the world," summarises Shah. **d**